A Seat for a Sea Tale

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 1

Four requests lay beside four books on the new Storyboat. The original ferry still had its own job elsewhere. This boat would bring library loans to Commons, Reed Creek, Farm Quay, and Mill Pond. Nib placed a splendid spare seat directly across the deck walkway. Lark stopped with the first book in her wings.

“A magnificent seat,” Nib announced. “A magnificent place to walk past it,” Lark suggested gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **my**

“In sea and seat, ea writes long e,” Lark modeled clearly. “It can sound like ee in see. Read sea, then add the ending sound for seat. We learn this spelling from these examples; other ea words may need different help.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try sea, seat, team. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read seat on the deck plan,” Lark invited gently. “Which supported place leaves the walkway clear?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **A team can see a seat. A seat is on a mat.**

“Who can see a seat?” Lark asked gently. “Where does the second sentence put it?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib moved the seat onto its marked supports. Lark packed Sea in the first dry compartment for Commons. Three other requested books went into separate compartments, their titles supplied aloud. The deck route stayed open. The lending record began with four requests and no loans yet completed.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write seat beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your first boat journal page showed a clear walkway. Before leaving, the crew needed to fit the dry chest's lid so it could open without striking the newly placed seat.

The Chest with Two Hinges

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 2

The chest lid rose and bumped the seat. Nib lowered it before it could scratch the wood. Its reversible hinge had been fitted on the walkway side. The four requested books remained dry in their compartments while Lark checked the fitting sketch.

“An enthusiastic lid,” Nib muttered. “A lid that needs room,” Lark replied calmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **sea**

“Ch writes the single sound at the beginning of chip and chest,” Lark modeled clearly. “It differs from the flowing sh in ship. Read chip and chest, keeping each letter team together. Bench has that same ch sound at its end.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try chip, chest, bench. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read chest on the fitting sketch,” Lark invited gently. “Which hinge side leaves space for both lid and seat?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **A chest is shut. A bench is by it.**

“What is beside the chest?” Lark asked gently. “Does the passage say the chest is open?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib laid the lid flat on a supported work board. Lark held it while he moved the hinge pins to the correct side. Once refitted, the lid opened into clear space. The seat stayed secure, the walkway stayed usable, and the books stayed dry. At Commons, the first landing ramp waited above its proper support slot.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write chest beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the corrected hinges in your journal. A lid could be enthusiastic without hitting anything now. The next job was making the ramp as useful to the cart as the chest was to the books.

The Ramp by the Cart

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 3

The small book cart caught at the ramp's raised end. Nib pushed once and made it more firmly stuck. Lark noticed the unused lower support slot at the landing. Sea waited safely in the cart; the other three books remained aboard.

“A cart is excellent at going,” Nib grumbled mildly. “A ramp helps with where,” Lark observed.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **chip**

“Ar gives the vowel sound in cart,” Lark modeled clearly. “Hear it as a joined part rather than a short a followed by a new syllable. Read cart, farm, and park with the pronunciation we use in speech.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try cart, farm, park. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read cart on the load diagram,” Lark invited gently. “Which slot puts its ramp against a real support?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **A cart is on a ramp. Sam can park it.**

“What can Sam park?” Lark asked gently. “Use the first sentence to explain it.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib backed the cart onto the level deck. Together they lowered the ramp into the proper slot and tested its seating. Lark steadied the side while Nib rolled the cart ashore. The wheels crossed the join smoothly. The Commons borrower waited near a supported shelf with two fern-marked papers beside it.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write cart beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal showed the supported ramp join. Sea had reached Commons, but the loan still needed the correct borrower and record. Arriving at a shelf was not the same as finishing the handoff.

The Fern on the Return Slip

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 4

Two papers bore a fern emblem. Nib held them side by side as if matching pictures settled everything. One was a current borrowing slip. The other was an old direction note. Sea rested on the cart while Lark checked what each page was for.

“Two ferns, one book,” Nib reported anxiously. “One current borrowing slip,” Lark replied carefully.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **cart**

“In fern, er works as a vowel spelling,” Lark modeled clearly. “Read her, fern, and stern using the sound in our ordinary speech. Knowing fern doesn't tell us which paper is current; the borrower picture and date space give different information.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try her, fern, stern. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read fern, then compare the two slips,” Lark invited gently. “Which one records this borrower and today's loan?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **A fern is by a cart. Her cap is on a shelf.**

“Where is the cap?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence describes the plant instead?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Lark supplied the date and place names. The current slip matched the waiting borrower's shelf. Nib placed Sea there, and Lark entered the loan once in the record. The old direction note stayed out of the lending ledger. One book was lent; Moon, Train, and Phone remained aboard for their later stops.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write fern beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

The Commons shelf kept Sea for its agreed loan time. Your boat turned toward the next bend, where a rope route passed too close to a bird's fixed perch.

The Bird and the Turn

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 5

A bird sat quietly above the first mooring post. Nib held the rope and considered whether the bird might prefer another branch. Lark found a second low post within the boat's safe reach. The bird's perch could remain exactly where it was.

“The bird has chosen an inconvenient branch,” Nib complained softly. “We can choose another post,” Lark replied kindly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **her**

“Ir in bird and ur in turn can spell the vowel we already met in fern,” Lark modeled clearly. “Read bird, turn, and fur. Similar sounds can have different spellings, so we look at the actual letters instead of swapping them in our minds.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try bird, turn, fur. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read turn on the mooring note,” Lark invited gently. “Which post lets the rope turn without entering the perch space?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **A bird can turn. Its wing is by a fern.**

“What is beside the fern?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence lets you check?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib brought the rope around the lower post while keeping its boat end attached. Lark checked the line from deck to shore. The boat settled securely at the bend, the cart route stayed clear, and the bird kept its comfortable branch. Ahead, two paths led toward Reed Creek's reading bank.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write turn beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the second post on your route page. Nobody needed to move the bird to make the boat safe. Now the crew could inspect the narrow path and the broad cart route from solid ground.

The Thin Path

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 6

The shorter path to Reed Creek was thin and raised. The longer path was broad, with room for the cart's wheels. Nib admired how quickly his feet could reach the narrow path's far end. Lark looked at the cart behind him and the walking-only picture on the route card.

“A short path,” Nib exclaimed hopefully. “A thin path,” Lark reminded him gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **bird**

“In thin and path, th writes one breathy sound,” Lark modeled softly. “Let air pass gently with your tongue near your teeth, without voice. Read thin, path, and bath. A different voiced th will have its own lesson; we aren't treating every th alike today.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try thin, path, bath. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read thin on the route card,” Lark invited gently. “Which path does the picture allow our cart to use?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **A thin path is by a farm. Sam can see it.**

“What can Sam see?” Lark asked softly. “Use the first sentence to explain it.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Lark scouted the thin path briefly on the wing. It reached the bank, but it had not grown wider. Nib brought the cart along the broad supported path instead. Both friends arrived at Reed Creek with the books intact. Two neighboring signs pointed toward opposite banks.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write thin beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal recorded the cart's actual route. A short way could be useful to feet and still be wrong for wheels. At the reading bank, the crew needed to decide which of the two signs was current.

This Bank, That Bank

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 7

Nib began arranging the reading mat beneath an old sign with splendid painted curls. Across the landing, a newer note pointed toward a reachable shelf. Lark laid the current landing picture beside both directions. One matched the place where your boat could actually stop.

“That sign has splendid curls,” Nib argued. “This bank has our landing,” Lark replied warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **thin**

“In this, that, and then, th uses voice,” Lark modeled clearly. “Compare it with the breathy beginning of thin. The little word the has voiced th too, with a soft weak vowel in this sentence. We'll model the whole word before asking you to read it.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try this, that, then, the. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read this bank on the current note,” Lark invited gently. “Which real landing matches its picture?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **This is the path. The cart is on that path.**

“Where is the cart?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence tells us?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib moved the portable mat to the bank identified by the current note. Lark fixed a clear updated sign there and marked the old direction as out of date. The reading place now matched the reachable shelf. Moon stayed aboard until its support was ready; choosing a bank had not yet completed the loan.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write this beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the actual landing on your journal page. Nib admired the older sign's curls one last time, then turned to the book request. The reader had asked for Moon, whatever the prettiest cover might show.

The Moon Book

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 8

Several closed books showed pale circles against dark skies. Nib chose the largest circle, delighted with its moonlike roundness. Lark held the borrower's request beside the actual title. Moon was a word as well as a picture, and only one of these covers carried that title.

“A very moon-shaped moon,” Nib insisted. “A word that says Moon,” Lark replied with amusement.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **this**

“Oo in moon and pool writes the long /oo/ sound,” Lark modeled clearly. “Join m, oo, n. The short words to and do have this sound with a single o; those special spellings need their own explicit model. We won't guess them from the ordinary short o.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try moon, pool, to, do. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read Moon on the closed covers,” Lark invited gently. “Which title matches the request?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The moon is up. I can get to the pool.**

“Where can the speaker go?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence gives a destination?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib returned the other books to their compartments. Moon came to the chosen Reed Creek landing. When he put it on a temporary round support, its lower edge began to slide. He caught it gently. The right book had arrived, but lending it still needed a stable reading rest and a completed record.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write moon beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal recorded the correct title. Lark kept Moon supported in her wings while Nib inspected the round rest. The next solution would need a broad foot rather than another beautiful circle.

The Book That Would Not Stay

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 9

The round support rolled beneath Moon. Nib tried holding the book with his nose, then discovered he could not turn a page. Lark lowered it onto the flat landing mat. The fitting diagram showed a wooden foot for the rest, waiting in the boat's small parts tray.

“A good book needs a good place to be a book,” Nib observed solemnly. “This one has one now,” Lark replied warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **moon**

“Oo has a different sound in book, look, and foot,” Lark modeled clearly. “Compare book with moon. We'll learn and practice each whole example rather than assuming one oo sound fits every word. Read foot on the fitting sketch after listening.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try book, look, foot. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read foot,” Lark invited gently. “Which broad part belongs under the unstable rest?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The book is on the rest. Its foot is on the mat.**

“What supports the book rest in our little passage?” Lark asked gently. “Look back at the second sentence.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib fitted the broad foot against the rest's base. The angled surface stayed still. Lark placed Moon on it and opened a page without needing anyone's nose. The Reed Creek borrower received the book, and Lark entered the second loan once. Train and Phone remained aboard for Farm Quay and Mill Pond.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write book beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Moon stayed with its borrower for the agreed time. Your boat left Reed Creek with two loans completed. At the next bend, a mooring line had wandered into the cart's route across the deck.

The Rope Around the Bow

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 10

Nib secured the mooring and found that the cart would not move. The rope ran through its handle space. The boat was tied, but so was the book cart. Lark kept the boat end attached while studying the route diagram for the line.

“The cart is very securely moored,” Nib admitted ruefully. “Let us moor the boat,” Lark suggested gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **book**

“Ou in out and ow in cow can write the same moving vowel sound,” Lark modeled clearly. “Read out, cow, and brown. The title's word bow needs its own spoken meaning from me today; we don't have to guess an unfamiliar use from a familiar-looking team.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try out, cow, brown. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read out on the diagram,” Lark invited gently. “Where should the line pass in relation to the cart route?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The brown cow is out. A book is on the cart.**

“What is outside?” Lark asked softly. “Which sentence describes the animal?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib moved the loose section outside the cart's travel space and around the proper bow fitting. The boat end stayed attached throughout the change. Lark checked the mooring before the cart rolled again. At Farm Quay, the next request card showed a railway picture and the title of the book its reader wanted.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write out beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal showed the boat held steady and the cart free. Two useful jobs no longer competed for the same space. The Farm Quay request could now be prepared without an accidental rope around its delivery cart.

The Train for Another Day

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 11

Train had a splendid folding railway picture. Nib wanted to put it on display at once. The Farm Quay request assigned that very book to a waiting borrower. Lark set the display tray beside the next-delivery tray so the difference could be seen as well as read.

“An excellent day for a train,” Nib exclaimed. “And a reader who requested one,” Lark added kindly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **out**

“Ai in train and rain writes long a,” Lark modeled clearly. “Ay in day and play can write that same sound. Compare them with a and silent e in make. The sound can match while the actual spelling stays different.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try train, rain, day, play. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read Train on the request,” Lark invited gently. “Which tray serves the reader who asked for it?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The train is in the rain. I can play by the cart.**

“What is in the rain?” Lark asked gently. “Find the subject of the first sentence.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib placed Train in the next-delivery tray and left the display book in its own place. The loan remained unrecorded while the boat approached Farm Quay. At the landing, an old direction board pointed toward closed bank stairs. A newer note showed a floating pontoon with an attached ramp.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write train beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew Train ready for its reader. The impressive foldout could wait to open in the right hands. First, the crew needed to use Farm Quay's current landing rather than its old closed stairs.

The Boat on the Note

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 12

The bank stair was roped closed. Beside it floated a broad pontoon, joined to shore by a ramp attached at both ends. Nib compared the old and new notes. Their boat pictures looked different because the landing itself had changed.

“The note has changed its boat,” Nib murmured suspiciously. “The landing changed first,” Lark explained gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **train**

“Oa in boat and coat writes long o,” Lark modeled clearly. “Ow can write long o in snow, a different sound from ow in cow. Read each example and check its meaning. We don't decide that a spelling always has its first learned sound.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try boat, coat, snow. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read boat on the current note,” Lark invited gently. “Which diagram matches the attached pontoon we can actually see?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The boat is by the dock. My coat is on the seat.**

“Where is the coat?” Lark asked softly. “Which sentence gives that information?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The boat reached the usable pontoon. Its ramp moved gently with the water while both attachments stayed secure. Nib checked the support before bringing Train toward shore. The borrower still needed the proper lending token, so the third entry remained pending in the record.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write boat beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal kept the current pontoon drawing. The old stairs stayed closed. At the quay's lending table, a coin-shaped token and a bright toy token waited for different purposes.

The Coin and the Toy

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 13

Nib admired the bright toy token on Farm Quay's table. A plain coin-shaped token lay beside the current borrowing slip. The toy belonged to another activity. Lark held Train's request next to the lending instructions while the book remained safely on its cart.

“A joyful toy,” Nib declared hopefully. “A useful coin-shaped token,” Lark replied with a smile.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **boat**

“Oi in coin and join writes the same vowel sound as oy in toy,” Lark modeled clearly. “Read coin and toy right through. Similar sounds don't make the objects interchangeable; their words and the instructions tell us their different jobs.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try coin, toy, join. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read coin on the lending instruction,” Lark invited gently. “Which token belongs with this borrowing slip?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The coin is by the toy. I can join the team.**

“Which two things are beside each other?” Lark asked gently. “Does the other sentence describe an object or a person joining?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib attached the coin-shaped lending token to Train's current slip. The toy stayed on its own activity tray. The borrower's identity and request now matched, but a hauling strap still stretched across the cart's exit. Lark kept the book aboard until that route was clear.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write coin beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark recorded the token check without marking the loan finished. Your journal showed the correct slip ready. One taut strap still had to leave the route before Train could reach its borrower.

The Haul Across the Lawn

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 14

The quay's unloaded hauling strap crossed the exit at handle height. Nib tried easing the cart under it. His handle caught immediately. Lark followed the strap back to its low storage hook, where it should have rested between hauling jobs.

“A strap has borrowed my handle,” Nib complained mildly. “We can give it its own hook,” Lark suggested.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **coin**

“Aw in saw and claw, and au in haul, write the modeled vowel sound in our speech,” Lark explained clearly. “Some speakers pronounce these vowels differently from others. We'll listen to our own clear examples, join their parts, and keep their meanings in view.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try saw, haul, claw. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read haul on the strap note,” Lark invited gently. “Where does its storage picture put the unloaded strap?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **I saw the cart. The team can haul it.**

“What can the team haul?” Lark asked softly. “Use the first sentence to explain it.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib backed the cart away. Lark released the unloaded strap from the crossing hook, and Nib settled it onto its own low storage hook. The cart's whole route was clear. Train and its lending token could now travel together toward the supported borrower shelf.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write haul beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

The journal showed the strap put away rather than stretched across a doorway. The hauling tool was ready for its next proper job. Your current job was finally bringing Train to the right shelf at the quay fork.

The Fork at the Port

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 15

Two low shelves stood at the port fork. One held workshop notices. The other was marked for current borrowers. Nib could see shore on both sides, but only one shelf matched Train's slip. Lark kept the token and book together while checking the last part of the handoff.

“More shores than I expected,” Nib remarked. “One borrower on this shore,” Lark replied carefully.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

saw

“Or in fork and corn, and ore in shore, represent the modeled sound in these words,” Lark explained clearly. “Read each with our ordinary pronunciation. A word like shore has familiar sh at the start and its own prepared vowel spelling at the end.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try fork, corn, shore. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the prepared shore label,” Lark invited gently. “Which shelf matches the actual borrower's slip rather than the workshop notice?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The fork is by the shore. The corn is on the cart.**

“Where is the corn?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence tells us about the cart?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Train reached the supported borrower shelf with its coin-shaped token. Lark entered the third loan exactly once. Sea remained at Commons and Moon at Reed Creek; nobody reclaimed those books to refill the boat. Phone was now the sole requested book still aboard. The boat turned toward Mill Pond.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write shore beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal marked Farm Quay complete. Nib could enjoy the idea of the foldout train reaching its reader. At Mill Pond, a record board had small cells for receipts and a separate tray for money.

The Cell for the Receipt

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 16

Nib began arranging the record board by shininess. The cent tray looked important, and a paper receipt looked rather plain. Lark set the current slip beside the board's empty receipt cell. Phone remained aboard until its reading place and borrower were ready.

“A cent in a cell?” Nib asked suspiciously. “A receipt in this cell,” Lark clarified gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **fork**

“C can say /s/ before e, i, or y in examples like cent and cell,” Lark modeled clearly. “Compare that with /k/ in cap. Read cent, cell, and ice using the sound we have explicitly modeled for each. These examples help us read the actual label.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try cent, cell, ice. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read cell on the record board,” Lark invited gently. “Where does the current receipt belong?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The cent is in the tray. The slip is in the cell.**

“Where is the slip?” Lark asked softly. “Which item stays in the tray?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib placed the receipt in its own cell and left coins in the money tray. The borrowing record was prepared without turning a receipt into a new loan. At the waiting reading rest, one short foot still needed a soft support pad before Phone could be set down.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write cell beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the two storage places in your journal. Records and money now had different homes. The last reading rest needed something practical beneath its short foot, whatever its shape might resemble.

The Gem-Shaped Pad

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 17

A glittering gem-shaped decoration and a soft gel pad had similar outlines. Nib chose the glittering one for the reading rest. It looked magnificent and rocked beneath the short foot. Lark brought the supplies note closer before anyone placed a book on top.

“A gem of a solution,” Nib exclaimed proudly. “A gel solution,” Lark corrected with amusement.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **cent**

“G can say /j/ in gem and gel,” Lark modeled clearly. “Compare the hard g in get, which keeps its own sound. Read gem and gel through their different last letters. The soft sound is prepared in these examples; we won't change every g we meet.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try gem, gel, age. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read gel on the supply note,” Lark invited gently. “Which material can settle beneath the short foot?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The gel is by the gem. I can get the gel.**

“Which thing can the speaker get?” Lark asked gently. “Read its last sound carefully.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib returned the gem to the decoration tray. The gel pad compressed beneath the rest's short foot, and the broad top stayed level. Lark tested it with a light touch before putting anything valuable there. Phone remained in the boat while the borrower's message tube was checked.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write gel beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal kept the useful pad beside the steady foot. Sparkle had not been the feature the rest needed. At the speaking tube, two wheels opened two different fittings, and the next note identified the right one.

Which Wheel to Turn

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 18

One wheel opened the speaking tube. The other opened a small shelf shutter. Nib turned the prettier wheel and found himself looking at an unrelated panel. Lark closed it gently and held the borrower's note beside the actual tube bracket.

“Which wheel is wonderfully round?” Nib wondered aloud. “Which wheel opens our tube?” Lark asked patiently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **gem**

“Wh begins when and wheel,” Lark modeled clearly. “Some families say it like w, and some keep a breathier sound. We'll use the way we speak. Why has the final y sound we already know. Read the examples without inventing an extra syllable.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try when, wheel, why. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read wheel on the note,” Lark invited gently. “Which pictured wheel opens the tube where we are meant to listen?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **When can I turn the wheel? The note has it.**

“What can answer the speaker's question?” Lark asked gently. “Find it in the second sentence.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib turned the correct wheel. The ordinary tube carried the waiting borrower's message clearly. Lark read back the confirmed request: Phone, the illustrated story of woodland messages. The book shelf stayed closed until that confirmation was complete. No fifth request had appeared.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write wheel beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark recorded the confirmed borrower. The steady reading rest was ready, the receipt cell was prepared, and one requested book remained to be selected by its actual title.

The Phone Book at the Pond

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 19

The last tray held several books with circles and bright lines on their covers. Lark kept the confirmed request beside them. Nib looked at each title before admiring the pictures. The waiting reader had asked for the history of messages called Phone.

“A phone with paper pages,” Nib murmured, delighted. “A story about messages,” Lark explained warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **when**

“Ph can write /f/ in phone and graph,” Lark modeled clearly. “The sound is familiar from fan, but this spelling needs its own model. Join ph with the long o pattern in phone. Keep the letter team together rather than sounding p and h separately.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try phone, graph. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read Phone on the closed covers,” Lark invited warmly. “Which title matches the confirmed request?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The phone is by the book. I can make a graph.**

“What can the speaker make?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence is about the phone instead?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib carried the selected book to the stable rest. Lark placed its current slip with the prepared receipt and entered the fourth loan once. All four requested books now had borrowers, destinations, and records. The Storyboat turned toward home with its lending job complete.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write phone beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal showed Phone on its borrowed reading rest. The four loans stayed with their readers for their agreed times. The boat could return to its berth for a celebration that matched the real lending record.

The First Storyboat Round

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 20

Four flags waited beside the berth. Nib wanted to raise them together. Lark laid out the lending record first: Sea at Commons, Moon at Reed Creek, Train at Farm Quay, and Phone at Mill Pond. Each flag needed a real completed loan behind it.

“Four flags,” Nib declared proudly. “Four readers with their books,” Lark added with satisfaction.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **phone**

“We can use the spellings we have already met,” Lark reminded you warmly. “Read boat and book, listening to their different vowels. Read train and phone with their prepared letter teams. Then check what each title means in our actual lending record.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try boat, book, train, phone. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Match the four slips to the four destination pictures,” Lark invited gently. “Which title is written on each current loan?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The boat has a book. The team can read it.**

“What can the team read?” Lark asked gently. “Which word does it refer back to?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The slips matched the four stops. Nib raised four flags. Visitors joined a shared shore reading while the lent books remained with their borrowers. A brass boat badge joined the collection. Lark bound your twenty chapters into The Storyboat, a record of the lending service you had helped make usable.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write boat beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

The fourth book joined the library. After the boat round was fully finished, a garden keeper brought a separate request for an illustrated maintenance guide. The flags marked completed loans, not promises of jobs still left undone.